

Amendment No. 1 to HB1658

White
Signature of Sponsor

AMEND Senate Bill No. 1709

House Bill No. 1658*

by deleting all language after the enacting clause and substituting:

SECTION 1. Tennessee Code Annotated, Title 49, Chapter 5, Part 1, is amended by adding the following as a new section:

(a) This section is known and may be cited as the "Tennessee Civics Education Act."

(b) Beginning July 1, 2027, a person seeking an initial license or an endorsement to teach in any of the grades six through twelve (6-12) in the subject of social studies, history, government, or civics must achieve a passing score on the United States civics test described in subdivision (c)(1) in order to obtain the license or endorsement.

(c) The department of education shall:

(1) Prepare a United States civics test composed of one hundred (100) questions collected from the questions that are set forth within the civics test administered by the United States citizenship and immigration services to persons seeking to become naturalized citizens;

(2) Beginning January 1, 2027, administer the United States civics test described in subdivision (c)(1) to persons seeking an initial license or an endorsement to teach students in any of the grades six through twelve (6-12) in the subject of social studies, history, government, or civics; and

(3) Provide a person who achieves a passing score on the United States civics test described in subdivision (c)(1) with a certificate of completion.

(d) A person must correctly answer at least seventy (70) questions to receive a passing score on the United States civics test described in subdivision (c)(1).

(e) The department shall not provide persons seeking an initial license or an endorsement to teach students in any of the grades six through twelve (6-12) in the subject of social studies, history, government, or civics with any remediation or civics instruction in preparation for the test described in subdivision (c)(1); provided, that the department shall provide links on its website to reference materials and instructional resources the department deems appropriate or helpful to such persons in preparation for the test.

SECTION 2. This act takes effect July 1, 2026, the public welfare requiring it.